Once the basics are covered, investors in training may want to add in further alternative investments such as REITs or commodities. They may also decide to invest in ETFs or companies that reflect their ethical and impact values.

Step #6: Choose where to invest

Choosing where to invest is one of the biggest barriers investors face. It can be so overwhelming it puts many investors off from being there in the first place, and it's a huge source of analysis paralysis.

There's a number of ways to invest, and we'll go through them all. But in short, one of the easiest and most cost effective ways to invest is through an online investing broker.

Online brokers

A broker used to be a person you'd call up to buy your investments from. They were the middleman, and sometimes they'd add a hint of pressure into their sales pitch, but thankfully we've moved away from that.

The most common type of online investing broker is a DIY one (think Robinhood). It's a website or app that acts as the communication portal between you and the stock exchange that you are interested in.

In every country there are online investing brokers. So how do you decide which one to go for? There are a few questions investors in training use to vet them.

1. *What exchanges and countries do they invest in?* For example, one broker in your country may be limited to the exchange in your country (e.g. just the NZX in New Zealand), while another broker will offer that plus the exchanges in the US.
2. *How easy is it to navigate the user interface?* It's like vetting a gym before starting a membership. Is it simple, well-lit and friendly or is it filled with gym rats who could probably snap you in half? If you don't feel comfortable, you're less likely to go back. In the beginning, having a brokerage site that you enjoy and that is easy to navigate can make all the difference.